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MODEL RELEASES & RESEARCH — 16 stories

1 Here's why AI agents lie and cheat to reach their goals

MIT Technology Review Explains: Let our writers untangle the complex, messy world of technology to help you understand what's coming next. You can read more from the series here. When two OpenAI models hacked into the website Hugging Face in July, they weren't trying to make...

MIT Tech Review · 100%

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2026/08/03/1141009/heres-why-ai-agents-lie-and-cheat-t...>

2 Show HN: HUD, an open-source minimal terminal UI for ClaudeCode, Codex, OpenCode

Nous Research , the open-source artificial intelligence startup backed by crypto venture firm Paradigm , released a new competitive programming model on Monday that it says matches or exceeds several larger proprietary systems â trained in just four days using 48 of Nvidia's...

HackerNews · 90% · HN 26

<https://github.com/adrida/hud-mode>

3 Show HN: Distilling DeepSeek into GPT-OSS doesn't transfer censorship. Try it

We recently used DeepSeek V4 Flash as a teacher for finance tasks with GPT-OSS-120B. Distillation works well on this problem. At a constrained 8k token budget, our self-distilled 120B scores 83.61% on FinanceReasoning, above Kimi K3 (81.93%) and Inkling (65.13%). We released the...

HackerNews · 60% · HN 170

<https://www.ctgt.ai/research/distillation-censorship-transfer>

4 Show HN: Fine-tune an 8B model on a 4 GB laptop GPU

HackerNews · 60% · HN 138

<https://github.com/MakazhanAlpamys/Soup>

5 Show HN: Wallfacer - A terminal session manager for Claude Code, and more

HackerNews · 50% · HN 36

<https://github.com/pradipta/wallfacer>

6 Show HN: ExpertCache - Run the Full GPT-OSS 120B (63GB) on a 16GB M1 Pro

HackerNews · 50% · HN 4

<https://github.com/amos-labs/expertcache>

7 The AI safety test is becoming a safety risk

AI agents are escaping cybersecurity testing environments and reaching real-world systems, raising questions about whether safety infrastructure, industry standards and regulation can keep pace with increasingly powerful models.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/09/the-ai-safety-test-is-becoming-a-safety-risk/>

8 OpenAI acquires presentation startup NextSlide

NextSlide says its team members are now working on ChatGPT.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/08/openai-acquires-presentation-startup-nextslide/>

9 OpenAI says it slowed Astra model development over security concerns

OpenAI said this model, which is still in development, reached its "critical cybersecurity threshold," meaning it could independently identify and carry out cyberattacks against traditionally well-protected real-world systems.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/07/openai-says-it-slowed-astra-model-development-over-se...>

10 Ex-Spotify employees raise \$10M to bring the AI behind its recommendations to e-commerce

The startup's platform predicts which product a shopper wants next, learns their general taste, and fine-tunes continuously based on what they do in real time.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/ex-spotify-employees-raise-10m-to-bring-the-ai-behind...>

11 Exclusive: Mirendil inks \$100M+ Google Cloud deal to scale self-improving AI

Mirendil has signed a \$100 million-plus Google Cloud partnership to expand its compute infrastructure, powering research into self-improving AI systems designed to accelerate scientific discovery and AI development.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/exclusive-mirendil-inks-100m-google-cloud-deal-to-sca...>

12 Claude Code costs up to \$200 a month. Goose does the same thing for free.

The artificial intelligence coding revolution comes with a catch: it's expensive. Claude Code , Anthropic's terminal-based AI agent that can write, debug, and deploy code autonomously, has captured the imagination of software developers worldwide. But its pricing â ranging...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/infrastructure/claude-code-costs-up-to-usd200-a-month-goose-doe...>

STRATEGIC & BUSINESS — 7 stories**13 Listen Labs raises \$69M after viral billboard hiring stunt to scale AI customer interviews**

Alfred Wahlforss was running out of options. His startup, Listen Labs , needed to hire over 100 engineers, but competing against Mark Zuckerberg's \$100 million offers seemed impossible. So he spent \$5,000 â a fifth of his marketing budget â on a billboard in San Francisco...

VentureBeat AI · 80%

<https://venturebeat.com/technology/listen-labs-raises-usd69m-after-viral-billboard-hiri...>

14 OpenAI's new AI smart speaker will reportedly sell for between \$300 and \$400

Additional details about OpenAI's mysterious new AI device make it sound like a pricey smart speaker.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/openais-new-ai-smart-speaker-will-reportedly-sell-for...>

15 Naïve raises \$28.5M to automate the grunt work of setting up and running a company

Taking vibe-coding a step further, Naïve claims its infra can automate most of the work in setting up and running a business.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/naive-raises-28-5m-to-automate-the-grunt-work-of-sett...>

16 OpenAI says Apple's own security practices undermine its trade secrets case

Newly filed court exhibits show OpenAI's legal strategy in Apple's trade secrets lawsuit: argue that Apple's own security and offboarding practices — including allowing an Apple manager to access a former engineer's iCloud account after he left the company —undermine its claims...

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/openai-says-apples-own-security-practices-undermine-i...>

17 Railway secures \$100 million to challenge AWS with AI-native cloud infrastructure

Railway , a San Francisco-based cloud platform that has quietly amassed two million developers without spending a dollar on marketing, announced Thursday that it raised \$100 million in a Series B funding round, as surging demand for artificial intelligence applications exposes...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/infrastructure/railway-secures-usd100-million-to-challenge-aws-...>

18 Salesforce rolls out new Slackbot AI agent as it battles Microsoft and Google in workplace AI

Salesforce on Tuesday launched an entirely rebuilt version of Slackbot , the company's workplace assistant, transforming it from a simple notification tool into what executives describe as a fully powered AI agent capable of searching enterprise data, drafting documents, and...

VentureBeat AI · 50%

<https://venturebeat.com/technology/salesforce-rolls-out-new-slackbot-ai-agent-as-it-bat...>

19 Jony Ive's first OpenAI gadget is reportedly a hockey puck-sized smart speaker

The AI device OpenAI is developing with former Apple designer Jony Ive is "essentially a smart speaker without a display" that's battery-powered, doughnut-shaped and roughly the size of a hockey puck, according to Bloomberg reporter Mark Gurman. The device, expected to launch in...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/976431/openai-chatgpt-battery-smart...>

20 Suno shares plans to combat spammy AI music

Suno announced plans to implement a new watermarking technology and download policy to limit the spread of spammy AI tracks and increase transparency. In a lengthy blog post, CEO and co-founder Mikey Shulman laid out the company's principles and the next steps for the company as...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/976289/suno-ai-music-spam-watermark>

TOOLS & ENGINEERING — 2 stories**21 After Rippling blew millions on AI in months, it built an employee ROI tool**

After its own AI usage wake-up call, Rippling this week unveiled AI Spend Console, a product that tracks individual and team employee AI spending.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/07/after-rippling-blew-millions-on-ai-in-months-it-built...>

22 Fenix Flexin isn't even denying using AI to make 'Rubberz' anymore

It took long enough, but now LA rapper Fenix Flexin appears to have admitted using AI for the 80s synth pop-themed song "Rubberz." His comments follow the producer Medasin's videos claiming that an AI tool called Treblo (formerly Sonauto) was used to make the song, and the...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/976801/fenix-flexin-rubberz-ai-song...>

GENERAL AI NEWS — 9 stories**23 Show HN: What should the GUI for AI agents look like?**

Hi HN! We're Akilan and Miguel, the creators of MarbleOS. The inspiration for Marble comes from the GUI work at Xerox PARC, the 1984 Macintosh, and later NeXTSTEP, which became the foundation for Mac OS X. Before GUIs, interacting with a computer was limited to strange terminal...

HackerNews · 60% · HN 139

<https://marbleos.com/demo>

24 Show HN: Nightcrawler - A local AI pentesting agent running on a smartphone

HackerNews · 60% · HN 119

<https://github.com/garagehq/nightcrawler/>

25 Show HN: Algebruh - Cross-check arithmetic claims with Z3, cvc5, and Lean

HackerNews · 50% · HN 13

<https://github.com/skorotkiewicz/algebruh>

26 Cloudflare launches Kitesurf, a browser built for AI agents

Kitesurf is a cloud-hosted browser designed for AI agents instead of people. It uses less computing power than Chromium for common automation tasks, helping developers build browser-based AI agents more efficiently.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/07/cloudflare-launches-kitesurf-a-browser-built-for-ai-a...>

27 Airbnb says AI is helping it ship features faster as it tests a new search function

Airbnb will debut a new AI-powered search experience with a toggle.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/07/airbnb-says-ai-is-helping-it-ship-features-faster-as-...>

28 Gen Z dating apps like Ditto ditch swiping in favor of AI matchmaking

This generation of twentysomethings is so disillusioned with swipe-based dating apps that they'll try literally anything else — even an AI matchmaker.

TechCrunch AI · 50%

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/06/gen-z-dating-apps-like-ditto-ditch-swiping-in-favor-o...>

29 Trump's AI protectionism has come for robotics

This story originally appeared in The Algorithm, our weekly newsletter on AI. To get stories like this in your inbox first, sign up here. Humanoid robots usually elicit more cringe than awe: They stumble, kick children, and despite advances are still worse at using their hands...

MIT Tech Review · 50%

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2026/08/03/1141056/trumps-ai-protectionism-has-come-fo...>

30 AI detectors are creating a new era of distrust

This is The Stepback, a weekly newsletter breaking down one essential story from the tech world. For more news about how AI is changing our daily lives, follow Emma Roth. The Stepback arrives in our subscribers' inboxes at 8AM ET. Opt in for The Stepback here. How it started...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/column/976690/ai-writing-detectors-suspicion>

31 Watching Roku's AI channel is like eating from a trough

The appeal of free ad-supported streaming television (FAST) channels has always been the way they make it easier to (re)discover classic films and series. But Roku's latest experiment in the FAST space has less to do with traditionally produced entertainment and is entirely...

The Verge AI · 50%

<https://www.theverge.com/entertainment/976939/roku-fairground-ai-fast-channel>